

Remote Work Policy

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Applies to: IronStore employees and long-term contractors in Europe

1. Purpose and Overview

IronStore supports remote and hybrid working where the arrangement is compatible with the role, customer commitments, operational requirements, and applicable employment law. The policy is intended to provide flexibility while maintaining service quality, information security, collaboration, and a consistent employee experience across European locations.

Remote work is a working arrangement, not an employee entitlement. Approval depends on business needs, role requirements, individual performance, and the ability to work securely from an approved location. The employee's employment contract, local law, and any country-specific addendum take precedence where requirements differ.

2. Scope

This policy applies to:

- Permanent and fixed-term employees working from IronStore offices or approved remote locations.
- Long-term contractors where their contract incorporates IronStore workplace policies.
- Employees working in customer service, fulfilment support, merchandising, technology, finance, HR, and corporate functions.
- Remote work performed within the employee's approved employing country.

This policy does not normally cover:

- Warehouse, delivery, retail-support, or other roles requiring physical presence.
- Temporary work-from-home arrangements during illness or medical leave.
- Business travel, relocation, or working from another country.
- Employees subject to a separate local remote-work agreement.

Working outside the employee's approved country requires prior approval under the International Work from Abroad Procedure (HR-REM-004).

3. Policy Statement

3.1 Working Models

IronStore uses the following working models:

- **Office-based:** Work is primarily performed at an assigned IronStore location.
- **Hybrid:** Work is performed at an IronStore location on designated days and remotely on other working days.
- **Remote-first:** Work is normally performed remotely, with attendance required for team events, planning sessions, training, or other business needs.

The hiring manager and People Partner confirm the working model during recruitment or internal transfer. The model is recorded in Workday and reviewed at least annually.

Most eligible hybrid employees are expected to attend their designated office an average of two days per week. Teams may set a higher attendance requirement during peak trading periods, operational changes, or major projects. Managers must provide reasonable notice, normally at least five working days, except for urgent business requirements.

3.2 Eligibility and Approval

Employees may request remote or hybrid work after completing their probationary period, unless an earlier arrangement is approved in writing.

Approval requires:

1. A request submitted through the Workday Flexible Work Request form.
2. Manager assessment of role suitability, performance, team coverage, and customer impact.
3. Review by the relevant People Partner.
4. Country-specific review where required by local employment law.
5. Written confirmation of the approved schedule, location, duration, and review date.

Managers should respond within 15 calendar days. An approval may be permanent, time-limited, or subject to a trial period of up to three months.

Requests may be declined where remote work would create unacceptable operational, security, collaboration, performance, or cost risks. The manager must document the reason and discuss alternatives with the employee.

3.3 Approved Work Location

The approved remote location must:

- Be within the employee's employing country.
- Provide a safe, suitable, and reasonably private working environment.
- Have reliable internet access and sufficient space for company equipment.
- Support confidentiality, video meetings, and uninterrupted work.
- Be recorded in Workday and kept current.

Employees must notify their manager and People Operations before changing their regular remote location. A move to another city or region may require a contract, tax, payroll, or workplace-safety review.

Remote work from cafés, public transport, shared accommodation, or public co-working spaces is permitted only for low-risk activities. Confidential discussions, customer data, payment information, and restricted documents must not be accessed or discussed in locations where they may be overheard or viewed.

3.4 Working Hours and Availability

Employees must work the hours stated in their contract and comply with local working-time requirements. Unless an alternative schedule is approved, employees should be available during their team's core hours:

- **Core hours:** 10:00–15:00 local time, Monday to Friday.
- **Customer and operational teams:** Hours specified by the team rota.
- **Cross-border teams:** Overlap periods agreed by the manager and recorded in the team handbook.

Employees must keep their status accurate in Microsoft Teams, attend required meetings, and respond to normal business messages within one working day. Calendar blocks should indicate focus time, breaks, annual leave, and other periods of unavailability.

Managers should assess outcomes rather than online presence. Monitoring employees through continuous webcam use, keystroke tracking, or unapproved surveillance tools is not permitted.

3.5 Attendance and Collaboration

Remote employees are expected to participate fully in team activities. Teams may require attendance at:

- Quarterly planning and performance meetings.
- Onboarding, training, workshops, and compliance sessions.
- Critical incident reviews or operational meetings.
- Customer, supplier, or leadership events.
- Office days published in the team calendar.

Meetings should use Microsoft Teams unless another approved platform is required. Important decisions must be recorded in the relevant Microsoft Teams channel, Confluence page, Jira ticket, or project record so that remote and office-based colleagues have equal access to information.

Managers should avoid unnecessary meetings and provide agendas or materials in advance. Employees who cannot attend must notify the organiser and review the available notes or recording.

3.6 Equipment, Expenses, and Office Setup

IronStore provides standard equipment based on role requirements. The normal package includes:

- Company laptop and charger.
- Headset and security key where required.
- External monitor for approved roles.
- Ergonomic accessories where supported by the local office or workplace assessment process.

All equipment remains IronStore property and must be returned when requested or when employment ends. Employees must not install unauthorised software or allow household members to use company devices.

IronStore does not normally reimburse furniture, home internet, electricity, heating, or rent unless required by local law or a written country addendum. Approved business travel to an IronStore office is reimbursed under the Business Travel and Expenses Policy (FIN-EXP-002). Equipment purchases require manager approval before ordering through Coupa.

Employees should report workstation or ergonomic concerns to Workplace Services. A workplace assessment may be arranged through the local occupational health provider.

3.7 Information Security and Privacy

Remote employees must comply with the Information Security Policy (SEC-001) and the following minimum controls:

- Use only IronStore-managed devices for company work.
- Connect through the IronStore VPN when accessing restricted systems.
- Use multi-factor authentication through Microsoft Entra ID.
- Lock the screen whenever leaving the workstation.
- Store business files in approved services, including OneDrive, SharePoint, and Confluence.
- Avoid printing confidential information; securely destroy any approved printouts.
- Use a privacy screen when working in public or shared areas.
- Never forward company data to personal email or storage accounts.
- Report suspected loss, phishing, or unauthorised access immediately through the ServiceNow Security Incident form.

A lost device or suspected data breach must be reported within one hour of discovery to the IT Service Desk and Information Security. Employees must not investigate, delete evidence, or contact affected customers unless instructed.

3.8 Health, Safety, and Wellbeing

Employees are responsible for maintaining a safe remote workspace and following local health and safety guidance. They must report accidents, work-related injuries, or unsafe conditions to their manager and People Operations as soon as possible.

Remote workers should:

- Take regular screen breaks and vary working posture.
- Keep cables and equipment clear of walkways.
- Use suitable lighting and ventilation.
- Separate work and personal time where practical.
- Raise workload, isolation, or wellbeing concerns early.

Managers must conduct regular one-to-one meetings and monitor workload, not just output. Employees may access the Employee Assistance Programme through the Wellbeing Hub. Participation is confidential, subject to the provider's terms.

3.9 Performance and Review

Remote employees remain subject to IronStore's normal objectives, performance, conduct, and attendance processes. A remote arrangement may be reviewed if:

- Performance or service levels decline.
- Required office attendance is repeatedly missed.
- Security or confidentiality requirements are breached.
- Team coverage or business needs materially change.
- The employee changes role, manager, country, or work location.

The manager should first discuss concerns with the employee and People Partner. Any change or withdrawal of the arrangement must be documented and communicated with reasonable notice, subject to local law.

4. Roles and Responsibilities

Employees

- Follow this policy, security controls, and local working-time rules.
- Maintain an approved work location and accurate availability.
- Protect company, customer, employee, and supplier information.
- Attend required office days and business events.
- Report incidents, health concerns, and changes in circumstances promptly.

Managers

- Assess requests consistently and without discrimination.
- Set clear objectives, schedules, and collaboration expectations.
- Ensure adequate team coverage and regular communication.
- Record decisions in Workday and review arrangements annually.
- Consult the People Partner before declining or withdrawing an arrangement.

People Operations and People Partners

- Maintain policy guidance and country-specific requirements.
- Advise on employment, tax, health, safety, and working-time considerations.
- Support formal flexible-work requests and appeals.

- Monitor policy application and required records.

IT and Information Security

- Provide approved equipment, access, and technical support.
- Maintain security controls for remote access.
- Investigate reported incidents and coordinate response actions.
- Manage device recovery and secure disposal.

5. Related Documents and References

- **HR-FLX-002:** Flexible Working Request Procedure
- **HR-REM-004:** International Work from Abroad Procedure
- **SEC-001:** Information Security Policy
- **SEC-007:** Acceptable Use and Device Standard
- **FIN-EXP-002:** Business Travel and Expenses Policy
- **H&S-003:** Home and Remote Workspace Safety Guide
- **PERF-001:** Performance Management Framework
- **GDPR-PRV-001:** Employee and Customer Data Protection Standard

Current documents are available in the IronStore Policy Centre on Confluence. Questions should be directed to the employee's manager, People Partner, or IT Service Desk, as appropriate.

6. Revision History

- **August 2026 — Version 3.0:** Added country-approval requirements, one-hour security reporting, core-hours guidance, and updated equipment controls.
- **January 2025 — Version 2.1:** Clarified hybrid attendance expectations and international work restrictions.
- **June 2023 — Version 2.0:** Consolidated office, hybrid, and remote-working guidance into one company-wide policy.